



BEHAVIORAL INTERVIEW GUIDE

*Developed by past successful applicants to
McKinsey, BCG, Deloitte, PwC Strategy& and
more*



RulerNetwork

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A breakdown of traits/skills and associated interview questions that top consulting firms ask you

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How to come up with compelling stories and examples for interview answers using the STAR method.

4

An extensive list of previously asked behavioural fit questions at top consulting firms (Find additional document attached).

This guide was developed by RulerNetwork's team of careers advisors and past successful applicants to McKinsey & Co, BCG, Oliver Wyman, PwC Strategy&, Deloitte and other top firms



INTRODUCTION:

What is the Behavioral Fit Interview?

What is the behavioral fit interview?



The behavioural interview – often referred to as behavioural fit interview or personal experience interview – is an integral part of the management consulting application process. It is typically conducted alongside the case interview.



Behavioural interviews are designed to assess whether applicants possess certain traits that firms are looking for. Therefore, understanding what these traits are first key step.



The next step would be to prepare answers that show you actually possess those traits. Preparing examples that demonstrate these skills/traits are the best way to prepare.

These examples should not just be any story, but something you can speak about at length and able to answer many follow up questions. You should also be ready to share specific details and actions within the example.

What is the behavioral fit interview?



We recommend having 3–4 stories prepared in the bank and these examples would be stronger if it can be molded into showing a range of different skills, this will prepare you for a wide variety of questions thrown at you.



When coming up with stories think of them as either success stories, failure stories, leadership stories etc. Typically, traits such as leadership & teamwork, proactivity & entrepreneurial drive often go hand in hand.



Although it is already widespread and commonly used, the STAR method still stands as the best way to framework for interview answers among successful applicants. Your examples should be structured using the STAR method.



BREAKDOWN OF TRAITS:

McKinsey&Company

BCG

BAIN & COMPANY

McKinsey&Company



Problem Solving Skills:

Case Interview:

- A unique, hypothetical client scenario will be given, and will assess your ability to identify important issues and form logical arguments.
- Make sure you prepare and present your answer in a structured manner.

Entrepreneurial Drive:

- Talk about a time when you had to work to achieve something in a limited period of time that was outside your comfort zone.



Inclusive Leadership:

- Share an example of an instance where you effectively worked with people with different backgrounds.



Personal Impact:

- Explain a challenging situation you encountered when working with someone with an opposing opinion to yours.

BCG:

Influence:

- Explain a situation where you had successfully led a team and achieved a set goal.
- Show your effectiveness as a good leader in high pressure environments and your experience in handling challenging situations.



Motivation:

- Talk about a situation where you had to complete a challenging task and how you motivated yourself to overcome this hurdle.



Team work:

- Share an example of an instance where you effectively worked with people with different backgrounds.



Achievements:

- Tell us about a situation you believe is your biggest professional achievement and why?



BAIN & COMPANY:

Leadership:

- Tell us about a situation where you displayed leadership and cooperation with your team members and managed a successful project.



Cultural values:

- Talk about a situation showing that you can relate to differing points of views, build a case for your own point of view, and be persuasive.



Focus:

- Share an example where you have had to face multiple challenging situations and how you overcame and prioritized each situation .



Drive:

- Explain a situation where you had to deal with an unforeseen problem and how your passion towards your project helped you overcome this problem.





STAR METHOD:

A simple framework for helping a candidate tell a meaningful story about a previous work experience or relevant events. Your BEST friend to answer behavioural interview questions!

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STAR METHOD:

1

S: SITUATION

Explain the Situation you were in, be as specific as possible. Examples include a volunteering experience, situations in your previous job or other relevant events.

2

T: TASK

What goal were you trying to achieve?

3

A: ACTION

What specific steps did YOU take to change the situation. Avoid using “we”, and use “I” instead; keep the focus on yourself!

4

R: RESULT

What was the consequence of your actions? Include positive change and positive results!

Encapsulate these traits through an effective interview strategy!

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